24 Days of Christmas Family Activities

A screen-free December countdown with one simple family activity a day

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13 PAGES

GM's Digital Creations

How to Use Your Countdown

One small activity a day turns December into a season of memories. Most need nothing you do not already have at home.

Getting started

1. Print the 24 activity cards and cut along the dashed lines.
2. Fold each card in half or tuck it in an envelope, a stocking or a pocket of a countdown calendar.
3. Each morning, open the card for that day and plan it into the evening.
4. Mark the day on the Countdown Tracker and write one line about what you did.
5. Busy day? Swap cards. The order is just a suggestion, and any card can move.
6. Use the blank cards to add your own family traditions.

What's inside

- How to use page
- 24 activity cards (6 pages, 4 per page)
- 8 blank cards for your own ideas
- Countdown Tracker
- Plan-Ahead Supply List
- Family Memories page

Good for

- Kids ages 4 to 12, with grown-ups helping the little ones
- Families who want less screen time in December
- Grandparents planning visits
- Classroom or homeschool countdowns (skip the at-home cards)

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

1

DECEMBER

Write letters to Santa

Everyone writes or draws a letter with three wishes and one kind thing they did this year.

Talk about it

If you could give anyone in the world a gift, who and what?

You'll need: Paper and pens

2

DECEMBER

Paper snowflake factory

Fold paper and cut snowflakes. Tape them to a window and count how many you made.

Talk about it

No two snowflakes are alike. What makes you one of a kind?

You'll need: Paper and scissors

3

DECEMBER

Cocoa and a story

Make hot cocoa and read a winter story together under a blanket.

Talk about it

What story would you want read to you every year?

You'll need: Cocoa mix and a book

4

DECEMBER

Kindness mission

Do one secret kind thing for a neighbor: shovel a step, leave a note or bring in their bin.

Talk about it

How do you think the neighbor felt? How did you feel?

Nothing to buy

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

5

DECEMBER

Holiday lights drive

Put on pajamas, grab a snack and drive or walk to see the best lights nearby.

Talk about it

Which house had the best lights, and why?

Nothing to buy

6

DECEMBER

Build a blanket fort

Build a fort in the living room with blankets and pillows. Eat a snack inside it.

Talk about it

If our fort were a castle, what would it be called?

You'll need: Blankets and pillows

7

DECEMBER

Call a grandparent

Call or video chat a grandparent or older relative. Ask about their favorite Christmas as a kid.

Talk about it

What did you learn about Christmas long ago?

Nothing to buy

8

DECEMBER

Bake cookies

Bake a simple batch of cookies together. Save a few to share tomorrow.

Talk about it

Who should get the very best cookie, and why?

You'll need: Cookie ingredients

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

9

DECEMBER

Share the cookies

Deliver yesterday's cookies to a neighbor, teacher or friend with a handwritten note.

Talk about it

What is the nicest thing someone has done for you this year?

You'll need: A plate or bag

10

DECEMBER

Family game night

Pull out a board game or card game and play as a family. Winner picks tomorrow's dessert.

Talk about it

What makes a game fun even when you lose?

You'll need: A game

11

DECEMBER

Thank-you cards

Make cards for people who help your family: mail carrier, bus driver, teacher, coach.

Talk about it

Who is a helper you see every week but rarely thank?

You'll need: Paper and markers

12

DECEMBER

Holiday movie night

Pick a family holiday movie, make popcorn and turn off the lights.

Talk about it

Which movie character would you invite for dinner?

You'll need: Popcorn

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

13

DECEMBER

Donate a toy

Each child picks a gently used toy or book to donate to a family who needs it.

Talk about it

How might a new toy change someone's Christmas?

You'll need: A bag

14

DECEMBER

Paper chain countdown

Make a paper chain with one link for each day left until Christmas. Tear one off each night.

Talk about it

How many days are left? What are you most excited for?

You'll need: Paper strips and tape

15

DECEMBER

Winter walk

Bundle up and take a walk. Look for five things: a pinecone, a bird, a wreath, a snowman, lights.

Talk about it

What sounds did you hear on the walk?

Nothing to buy

16

DECEMBER

Sing-along night

Play your favorite holiday songs and sing loudly. Bonus points for a dance-off.

Talk about it

Which song puts you in the best mood?

Nothing to buy

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

17

DECEMBER

Family photo

Take a silly family photo in holiday colors. Print it or send it to someone far away.

Talk about it

Who should we send this photo to first?

You'll need: A phone or camera

18

DECEMBER

Jar of thanks

Each person writes three things they are thankful for this year on slips of paper. Read them aloud.

Talk about it

What is one hard thing this year that turned out okay?

You'll need: Paper and a jar

19

DECEMBER

Breakfast for dinner

Make pancakes or waffles for dinner and let the kids pick the toppings.

Talk about it

What is the silliest topping combo you would try?

You'll need: Pancake ingredients

20

DECEMBER

Wrap a gift together

Wrap a present for someone in the family. Practice your best secret-keeping face.

Talk about it

What gift would you love to give but can't buy in a store?

You'll need: Paper and tape

Activity Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

21

DECEMBER

Tell family stories

Turn off screens, light a candle and share a funny or happy memory from a past Christmas.

Talk about it

Which memory made everyone laugh the most?

Nothing to buy

22

DECEMBER

Pajama picnic

Spread a blanket on the floor and have a picnic dinner in pajamas.

Talk about it

Where would you have a picnic anywhere in the world?

You'll need: A blanket

23

DECEMBER

Leave a treat out

Set out a treat for Santa and a carrot for the reindeer. Write Santa a short note.

Talk about it

What would you ask Santa if you could ask one question?

You'll need: A treat and a carrot

24

DECEMBER

Christmas Eve slow down

Read a Christmas story, then each person says their favorite day from this countdown.

Talk about it

What day of this countdown will you remember most?

Nothing to buy

Your Own Activity Cards

Write your own family traditions on these cards.

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

Your Own Activity Cards

Write your own family traditions on these cards.

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

DAY ___ DECEMBER

Countdown Tracker

Color in each day as you go and jot one line about it. By Christmas Eve you will have a full page of memories.

Day	Activity	What we did or loved	Done
1	Write letters to Santa		
2	Paper snowflake factory		
3	Cocoa and a story		
4	Kindness mission		
5	Holiday lights drive		
6	Build a blanket fort		
7	Call a grandparent		
8	Bake cookies		
9	Share the cookies		
10	Family game night		
11	Thank-you cards		
12	Holiday movie night		
13	Donate a toy		
14	Paper chain countdown		
15	Winter walk		
16	Sing-along night		
17	Family photo		
18	Jar of thanks		
19	Breakfast for dinner		
20	Wrap a gift together		
21	Tell family stories		
22	Pajama picnic		
23	Leave a treat out		
24	Christmas Eve slow down		

Plan-Ahead Supply List

7 of the 24 activities need nothing at all. Gather these few things in late November and December runs itself.

Supply	Used on day	Have it
A bag	13	
A blanket	22	
A game	10	
A phone or camera	17	
A plate or bag	9	
A treat and a carrot	23	
Blankets and pillows	6	
Cocoa mix and a book	3	
Cookie ingredients	8	
Pancake ingredients	19	
Paper and a jar	18	
Paper and markers	11	
Paper and pens	1	
Paper and scissors	2	
Paper and tape	20	
Paper strips and tape	14	
Popcorn	12	

Our Family Memories

Fill this in together on Christmas Day or New Year's Day. Keep it with your decorations to read next year.

Our favorite activity this year

The funniest moment

Something kind we did for someone else

A new tradition we want to keep

Next year, let's try

You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

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